to break free. I am reminded of the famous passage near the end of Gogol's *Dead Souls*. Comparing his nation to a speeding troika, Gogol asks what will be its destination. But he writes, "There was no answer save the bell pouring forth marvelous sound."

We do not know what the conclusion will be of this journey, but we're hopeful that the promise of reform will be fulfilled. In this Moscow spring, this May 1988, we may be allowed that hope: that freedom, like the fresh green sapling planted over Tolstoi's grave, will blossom forth at last in the rich fertile soil of your people and culture. We may be allowed to hope that the marvelous sound of a new openness will keep rising through, ringing through, leading to a new world of reconciliation, friendship, and peace.

One of my regrets as president is that I was never able to take Mikhail Gorbachev on a trip across our country: I wanted to take him up in a helicopter and show him how Americans lived.

"You choose the route," I was going to say. "I don't want you to think we're showing you a Potemkin Village. We'll go where you want to go . . ."

Then, from the air I would have pointed out an ordinary factory and showed him its parking lot filled with workers' cars, then we'd fly over a residential neighborhood and I'd tell him that's where those workers lived—in homes with lawns and backyards, perhaps with a second car or a boat in the driveway, not the concrete rabbit warrens I'd seen in Moscow—and say:

"They not only live there, they *own* that property."

I even dreamed of landing the helicopter in one of those neighborhoods and inviting Gorbachev to walk down the street with me, and I'd say, "Pick any home you want; we'll knock on the door and you can ask the people how they live and what they think of our system."